



For most of its history, the Avengers employed a rotating chairmanship that allowed different acting members to chair meetings and make administrative decisions. Captain America usually served as team leader in the field.

equipment, weaponry, security countermeasures and computer systems. He also used his government contacts to lobby for A-1 or Avengers Priority security clearance to aid the team's operations.

The Avengers began to establish themselves by fighting foes like the SPACE PHANTOM, the LAVA MEN, THE MOLE MAN, BARON ZEMO, his MASTERS OF EVIL and KANG. The team also met Wonder Man who later sacrificed himself to save them. All of the founding members eventually left the team, leaving CAPTAIN AMERICA in charge with a band that first consisted of HAWKEYE, the SCARLET WITCH and QUICKSILVER. The Wasp and Hank Pym, who had exchanged his Ant-Man to become the first Goliath, returned to the team. The Olympian demigod HERCULES also became a member. Serving as an agent for the MANDARIN, the first Swordsman even attempted to join.

THE OLD ORDER CHANGETH

Accidentally created by Hank Pym, the robot ULTRON tried to kill the Avengers. He even built the android VISION, who betrayed him and served as an Avenger for many years. Haunted by guilt, Pym's marriage to the Wasp deteriorated and he left the team.

The Avengers fought alongside the alien CAPTAIN MAR-VELL in a cosmic battle that came to be known as the Kree-Skrull War. The membership continued to change as the BLACK WIDOW, the BEAST, the now-reformed Swordsman, MANTIS, and HELLCAT all became members. A romance developed between the

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

- **Avengers #4** The Avengers rescue Captain America from an icy tomb and invite him to join the team.
- **The Greatest Battles of the Avengers (tpb)** The Avengers fight many of their most deadly foes.
- **Avengers: The Korvac Saga (tpb)** The Guardians of the Galaxy help the Avengers battle Michael Korvac.
- **Avengers: Under Siege (tpb)** The new Baron Zemo and his Masters of Evil attack Avengers Mansion.
- **Avengers: Disassembled** The Scarlet Witch warps reality and attacks her former teammates.

THE ULTIMATES

On a parallel Earth, government scientists created a super-soldier formula, but lost it when Captain America disappeared during World War II. Many years later, Dr. Bruce Banner was hired to recreate it. Working out of a rundown research facility in Pittsburgh, he engaged in secret superhuman trials on civilians and even tested the formula on himself, transforming himself into the rampaging Hulk. General Nick Fury took custody of Banner and ordered him to complete his research in order to create a new super-team called the Ultimates. This team included Dr. Hank Pym, a cybertronics expert and a world authority on super-genetics.

THE ULTIMATES (2004)

1 Giant-Man 2 Iron Man 3 Hawkeye 4 Wasp 5 Captain America 6 Black Widow 7 Thor



When Kang the Conqueror and his son Marcus waged all-out war against the Earth, the Avengers led the planet's defensive effort. Although Kang temporarily succeeded in subduing the entire world, the Avengers led a resistance movement that eventually overthrew his new dynasty.

When the Avengers disappeared while battling Onslaught, those on the Earth they left behind believed them dead.

VISION and the Scarlet Witch and they married.

The National Security Council began to take an active interest in the team and appointed Henry Peter GYRICH liaison officer. He tried to control team membership by recruiting FALCON and Ms. Marvel (see WARBIRD). In recent years, JUSTICE, FIRESTAR, TRIATHLON, SILVERCLAW, JACK OF HEARTS, ANT-MAN and a new female CAPTAIN BRITAIN served as members.

HEROES REBORN AND RETURN

At one point, the Avengers became embroiled in an epic battle with the villain ONSLAUGHT, and they, the FANTASTIC FOUR, and DR. DOOM were all presumed to have perished. Actually, Franklin Richards had used his reality-altering powers to save them at the last moment and transport them into a pocket dimension of his own creation, which featured a copy of Earth called Counter-Earth. They came back after a year. Later, Counter-Earth became situated on the opposite side of the sun from the Earth.

TD, MF

